AYUSHMAN BHARAT PRADHAN MANTRI JAN AROGYA YOJANA (AB PM-JAY)

1. SCHEME OVERVIEW & OBJECTIVES
Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) is the flagship national health protection scheme of the Government of India.
It aims to provide financial risk protection against catastrophic healthcare expenditures to vulnerable families across the nation.

2. CORE BENEFITS AND SUM INSURED
- Benefit Cover: Rs. 5,00,000/- (Rupees Five Lakhs only) per eligible family per year for secondary and tertiary care hospitalization.
- Cashless & Paperless: The scheme provides completely cashless and paperless access to healthcare services at all Empanelled Health Care Providers (EHCPs), including public and empaneled private hospitals.
- Coverage Scope: Over 1,949 medical and surgical procedures across 27 specialties including cardiology, oncology, neurosurgery, orthopedics, and pediatric surgery.
- Pre and Post Hospitalization: Covers diagnostic expenses and consultations up to 3 days prior to admission and medicine expenses up to 15 days following discharge.
- Pre-existing Conditions: All pre-existing medical conditions and chronic diseases are covered from Day 1 of enrollment. No waiting periods apply.
- Family Cap: There is no restriction on family size, age, or gender. All eligible family members are covered under the single family sum insured of Rs. 5 Lakhs.

AB PM-JAY: ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA & EXPANSION

3. BENEFICIARY ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA (SECC 2011 BASELINE)
Rural Beneficiaries: Automatically eligible if classified under deprivation criteria D1 through D7 in Socio-Economic Caste Census (SECC) 2011:
- D1: Only one room with kuccha walls and kuccha roof.
- D2: No adult member between ages 16 to 59.
- D3: Female-headed households with no adult male member between ages 16 to 59.
- D4: Disabled member and no able-bodied adult member in the household.
- D5: SC and ST households.
- D7: Landless households deriving major part of income from manual casual labor.

Urban Beneficiaries: Eligible based on 11 occupational categories of urban workers:
Ragpickers, beggars, domestic workers, street vendors, cobblers, hawkers, construction workers, plumbers, masons, painters, security guards, transport workers, conductors, cart pullers, and sanitation workers.

4. UNIVERSAL SENIOR CITIZEN COVERAGE (AGE 70 AND ABOVE)
- In September 2024, the Union Cabinet approved universal health coverage under PM-JAY for all senior citizens aged 70 years and above, regardless of income or socio-economic background.
- For Senior Citizens in Existing PM-JAY Beneficiary Families: A separate additional top-up cover of up to Rs. 5 Lakh per year is provided exclusively for the senior citizen(s), which does not need to be shared with other family members.
- For Senior Citizens Not in Covered Families: A dedicated family cover of up to Rs. 5 Lakh per year is provided.
- Coordination: Senior citizens already enrolled in Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS), Ex-Servicemen Contributory Health Scheme (ECHS), or Ayushman CAPF may choose between their current scheme or PM-JAY.

AB PM-JAY: CARD ISSUANCE, PORTABILITY AND PROCEDURE

5. CARD GENERATION AND VERIFICATION
- Every eligible beneficiary is issued an individual 'Ayushman Card' (formerly known as Golden Card) with a unique AB-PMJAY ID.
- Required Documents for Verification: Aadhaar Card or valid Government photo identity, along with Ration Card or proof of family relation.
- Verification Channels: Beneficiaries can verify their eligibility and download cards via:
  a) Official portal: pmjay.gov.in ('Am I Eligible' portal)
  b) Ayushman App (available for Android smartphones with Aadhaar face authentication)
  c) Common Service Centres (CSCs) and Village Level Entrepreneurs (VLEs)
  d) Ayushman Mitra Helpdesks established at all empanelled public and private hospitals
- National Toll-Free Helpline: 14555 (accessible 24x7 in multiple Indian languages).

6. NATIONWIDE PORTABILITY
- Beneficiaries can access cashless treatment across any empaneled hospital anywhere in India, irrespective of their state of residence or native domicile.
- Interstate hospital treatments are reimbursed seamlessly through the National Health Authority clearing system.